

## SYNTEN INC

# Authorization Decline Incident Triage Runbook

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|-----------------|--------------------------------------|
| Document key    | RB-001                               |
| Document ID     | 66a84fed-3d77-4e7e-9a1b-e25ff37e2280 |
| Version / type  | 2.1.0 / RUNBOOK                      |
| Status          | APPROVED                             |
| Owner           | Payment Operations                   |
| Effective       | 2026-08-30T09:00:00Z                 |
| Incident family | AUTHORIZATION_DECLINE_RATE_SPIKE     |
| Classification  | Internal - Synthetic Demo            |

**Synthetic demonstration data only. No real payments, customers, merchants, credentials, or company records.**

## Document control

| Control           | Value                                                                                    |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Owner             | Payment Operations                                                                       |
| Audience          | Payment Operations Analyst, Incident Commander, and named technical owner                |
| Review cadence    | Every 180 days and after a material synthetic scenario change                            |
| Related documents | PL-001, PL-002, PL-003                                                                   |
| Retrieval role    | Initial assessment, evidence status, time-window comparison, and escalation entry point. |
| Classification    | Internal - Synthetic Demo                                                                |

## Revision history

| Version | Status   | Date       | Summary                                                            |
|---------|----------|------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2.1.0   | APPROVED | 2026-08-30 | Controlled corpus version for authorization-decline investigation. |

## 1. Purpose and scope

This runbook guides a human analyst investigating card authorization incident triage. Its operational purpose is: Initial assessment, evidence status, time-window comparison, and escalation entry point. It applies only to persisted SynTen Inc synthetic evidence for the current tenant and investigation.

The runbook does not establish that a described failure occurred. An alert is a signal; approved knowledge is guidance; probable cause remains an inference that must be supported by cited evidence.

## 2. Entry conditions and authority

- Confirm the incident is INVESTIGATING and the tenant and investigation identifiers match the evidence request.
- Record the alert window, evidence observation window, collection status, source, and retrieval timestamp before interpretation.
- Stop and preserve the gap when evidence is unavailable, malformed, stale, cross-tenant, or outside the incident window.
- Use this document to diagnose and prepare an escalation. The copilot may not execute recovery, approve a report, or contact an owner.

## 3. Evidence prerequisites

| Evidence                  | Minimum check                                                                         | Why it matters                                                              |
|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Service-error observation | Persisted status, service name, bounded UTC window, exact codes, and aggregate counts | Separates observed facts from a generic runbook match.                      |
| Alert context             | Detected time, received time, duration, affected opaque route or cohort, and severity | Establishes the comparison window and operational scope.                    |
| Knowledge context         | Approved document version, chunk identity, and retrieval status                       | Makes later recommendations traceable without treating guidance as proof.   |
| Independent confirmation  | Named source or owner when the runbook calls for it                                   | Prevents a single synthetic signal from becoming an unsupported conclusion. |

## 4. Triage decision flow

1. Verify tenant, incident, and investigation correlation before reading any technical signal.
2. Compare alert detection and duration with the evidence observation window; mark non-overlap as a limitation.
3. Classify evidence as positive observation, valid negative evidence, partial coverage, unavailable, timed out, or malformed.
4. Group exact error codes by dependency family: gateway, service state, routing, network, security, cryptography, response mapping, or cohort configuration.

- Retrieve approved guidance for the strongest observed family and retain weak or conflicting candidates for reviewer context.
- Stop with INSUFFICIENT\_EVIDENCE when no approved source supports a probable cause and recommendation.

## 5. Evidence status matrix

| Status                   | Analyst treatment                                         | Report effect                                         |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| AVAILABLE with errors    | Cite exact codes, counts, source, and time window.        | May support an observation and bounded inference.     |
| AVAILABLE and empty      | Record successful negative evidence.                      | Lowers support for causes expected in that window.    |
| PARTIAL                  | State returned and missing partitions.                    | Preserve gap; normally lower confidence.              |
| UNAVAILABLE or TIMED_OUT | Retain the failed attempt and status detail.              | No cause from that source; seek independent evidence. |
| Malformed                | Reject payload as evidence and retain validation failure. | Never repair or infer missing values.                 |

## 6. Handoff checkpoint

The analyst hands off a fact/inference split: observed source results, candidate dependency family, contradictory or missing evidence, approved runbook/policy references, and the next named owner confirmation. No handoff may claim remediation has occurred.

## 7. Failure and uncertainty handling

- AVAILABLE with an empty error list is valid negative evidence for that exact source and window; it is not an unavailable result.
- PARTIAL means missing partitions may contain confirming or contradictory observations. State the missing scope and use LOW confidence unless independent evidence closes it.
- UNAVAILABLE or TIMED\_OUT means no technical cause can be concluded from this source. Preserve the attempt and seek an approved independent source.
- Contradictory timestamps, routes, instance groups, or error ordering must appear in the report as contradictions, not be averaged away.
- A retrieved weak match may suggest a check, but it cannot override stronger observed evidence or an approval-status filter.

## 8. Escalation package

Escalate to Payment Operations with the incident and investigation identifiers, bounded UTC window, service name, exact error codes and counts, affected opaque route or cohort, evidence status, selected knowledge references, contradictions, and the next requested human confirmation.

Do not include credentials, raw provider payloads, private endpoints, plausible merchant data, or an unreviewed model conclusion. Record the receiving owner and next checkpoint; sending the package remains a human action outside the copilot.

## 9. Validation and closure checks

- Recollect the same approved evidence source only through a separately authorized operator action and compare equivalent windows.
- Confirm whether the named error categories and decline-rate signal have returned toward the synthetic baseline.
- Record any separately authorized change, its owner, validation result, and rollback decision without attributing it to the model.
- Generate a report only from persisted evidence and retrieval snapshots; review every citation before approval or rejection.

5. Retain failed attempts, negative evidence, and superseded hypotheses in the audit timeline.

## 10. Related documents

Use PL-001, PL-002, PL-003 for adjacent diagnostic or governance requirements. Only approved and effective versions are retrieval eligible.

## 11. Required investigation record

Complete the following record in the incident workspace before requesting review. Use explicit Not observed, Unavailable, or Not applicable values instead of leaving fields blank.

| Record group | Required entry                                                                                                                                                                       | Reviewer checkpoint                                                            |
|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Correlation  | Tenant ID, incident ID, investigation ID, alert ID, and UTC observation window                                                                                                       | All identifiers resolve to the same tenant-scoped investigation.               |
| Evidence     | Source, collection status, retrieval time, exact codes, aggregate counts, and missing partitions                                                                                     | Observations are distinguishable from unavailable or partial evidence.         |
| Knowledge    | Document key, version, approval status, retrieval query, and selected chunk references                                                                                               | Every cited item was approved and effective at retrieval time.                 |
| Assessment   | Observed facts, candidate inference, confidence, alternatives, contradictions, and limitations                                                                                       | The inference does not exceed the cited evidence.                              |
| Handoff      | Receiving owner, requested confirmation, next checkpoint, and escalation time                                                                                                        | The request is bounded and no operational action is attributed to the copilot. |
| Review       | Handoff state (READY FOR REVIEW, INSUFFICIENT EVIDENCE, or ESCALATED FOR CONFIRMATION), reviewer identity and time, accepted or rejected citations, disposition, and follow-up owner | Approval and operational action remain human decisions outside this runbook.   |